

REACH SOCIAL CASE STUDY

Category: health and wellness (TikTok Shop affiliate)

\$500 In, \$3,500 Out. 600% ROI, and the Campaign Was Only Half Done.

A health and wellness brand turned one creator retainer into a 600% return by the three-week mark. The leverage was not the creative. It was the rate negotiated before the deal started.

• VERIFIED TIKTOK SHOP PARTNER

600%

ROI, HALFWAY IN

\$500

IN

\$3,500

OUT, SO FAR

01 Setup

A health and wellness brand on TikTok Shop running an affiliate program, where the Reach team manages creator retainer relationships. The specific win came from one retainer collab: a paid arrangement with a single creator, structured to deliver a return rather than just buy content.

02 Problem

Retainers carry upfront cost risk. You pay the creator regardless of how the content performs, which means the ROI is decided before the campaign even runs, by how the deal is structured. A retainer at the wrong rate locks in a loss no creative can save. The question going in was whether this specific deal was built to return, or just to spend.

03 The Negotiated Retainer Flip

The Negotiated Retainer Flip puts the work where the return is actually won: in the rate negotiation, before any money is committed. Instead of accepting a creator's standard retainer and hoping the content carries it, the team actively managed the relationship and negotiated the rate to set a return floor up front. Get the rate right and the deal is profitable on day one. Get it wrong and no

amount of performance fixes it. The flip is moving ROI from a hope to a structural feature of the contract.

04 The moves



Manage the relationship

Actively managed the retainer relationship with the creator rather than treating it as a set-and-forget contract.



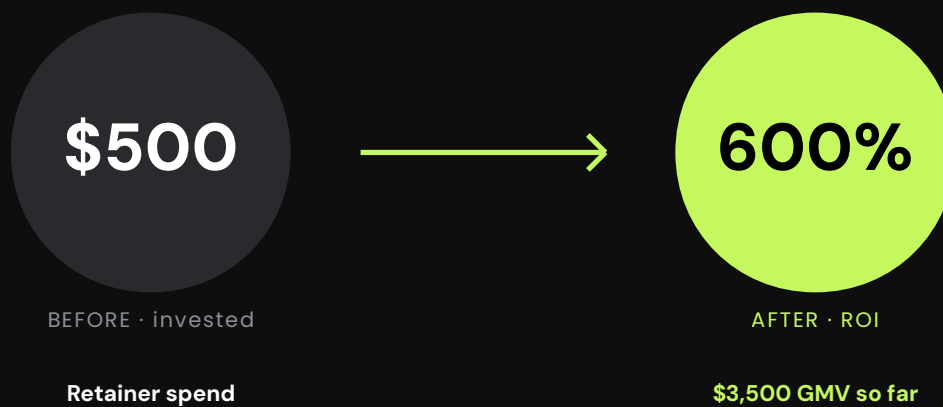
Negotiate the rate

Negotiated the retainer rate up front for a higher ROI chance, setting a return floor into the deal before committing spend.

05 Result

At the three-week mark, with the campaign not yet halfway complete, the retainer had returned 600% ROI: \$500 invested, \$3,500 in GMV generated. Kept faithfully to the source: those figures are as of the halfway point, not a final campaign total. The math checks out at a 7x multiple on spend, and the campaign still had room left to run.

THE RETAINER MATH, AT THE HALFWAY MARK



ROI on the retainer collab as of the 3-week mark, with the campaign not yet complete. \$500 spent, \$3,500 GMV generated.

600%

ROI AT THE HALFWAY MARK

\$500

RETAINER SPEND

\$3,500

GMV GENERATED SO FAR

Six hundred percent with the campaign half over is a strong number on its own. The more useful point is where it came from. This return was not produced by a viral moment or a lucky post. It was structured into the deal at the negotiation table, before the first piece of content went live, which is exactly why it is repeatable.

Retainer deals on TikTok Shop are not set-and-forget, and they are not won in the content. They are won in the rate you negotiate before you commit. The transferable move: treat every retainer rate as the moment you decide your ROI, push for a return floor up front, and manage the relationship actively after. The brands that profit from creator retainers are the ones who do the math before they sign, not after.

Want your creator retainers to return like this?

Book a TikTok Shop intro call →

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